This Manual is joyfully dedicated to the thousands who are involved in securing gifts for their organizations. You are involved in towering and noble work. You provide the necessary funds for your organization to make the greatest possible impact. Through your efforts, lives will be changed. Lives will be saved.

—William T. Sturtevant & Jerold Panas

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*Appendix A (Putting It All Together) is meant for board members, volunteers, and other *Natural Partners*. You may wish to duplicate it and pass it on to volunteers who are assisting you in the program. It is a short course on Moves Management™.

THE JOURNEY BEGINS

This Manual is intended as a practical guide to the effective implementation of Moves Management™. The concept emphasizes long-term, interpersonal relationships with donors. The result is raising gifts of significance for worthy causes of all types and sizes.

The Manual provides a fail-proof model in your quest to secure major gifts, whether current or deferred. It is your road map. And all the signposts lead the way to success.

In a nutshell:

- Moves Management™ is a system for building deep, life-long affinity and commitment with probable donors. These relationships reliably lead to major gifts. This is true no matter how your organization defines a major gift.
- Each major gift probable donor is assigned to a *Moves Manager*. This is the person who makes certain that the donor is appropriately cultivated, solicited, and thanked for his or her generosity. The *Moves Manager* is the professional fundraiser.
- The *Moves Manager* relies on help from *Natural Partners*. These can be friends, relatives, business associates, and social acquaintances of the

probable donor. *Natural Partners* can also be representatives from the organization— the CEO, Deans, campaign directors, whatever.

These partnerships may already exist or they may be appropriately created. The *Natural Partners* help create and implement a strategy for securing a major gift. They also participate in the cultivation, solicitation, and acknowledgement of the donor.

- The *Moves Manager* also identifies a *Primary Player*— the natural partner to whom the probable donor would have the most difficulty saying "no." Ideally, this person asks for the gift.

- A "move" is any interaction that penetrates a probable donor's consciousness. In other words, it makes an indelible impact on the person.

  Moves cover the whole range of the major gift process. It begins with the identification of the probable donor to finally the acknowledgement of the gift. All moves must have a specific, desired outcome that leads naturally to a planned next step.

- Each time you make contact with a probable donor, you should have a best- and worst-case strategy. You need to be prepared for the probable donor turning down your invitation or a request for funds.

- Start small in implementing Moves Management™. At least initially, limit each *Moves Manager* to 10 to 50 individuals. The quality of your relationships counts more than the number of people in your portfolio.

- Meet regularly to set thoughtful, concrete strategies for your highest-level probable donors. Revise as necessary over time. Consult regularly with your colleagues and *Natural Partners*. It is a team effort.

- Record probable donor information that you and others will need to know. Be faithful about reporting your contacts. This is invaluable for future visits.

- Get out the door. Use Moves Management™ to maintain and deepen relationships and secure major gifts.

"Wow! What a great day to begin my Moves Management™."

How It All Began

Fundraising by philanthropic organizations is a major force in our economy. More development people are raising more money from more donors than ever before.

At least five converging phenomena have created this situation: (1) the rapid increase in the number of nonprofit organizations; (2) the spiraling number of professional development people; (3) the cutbacks in government subsidies and grants— particularly in the arts, social service agencies, and state universities; (4) the greater dependency of hospitals on philanthropy; and (5) the swelling demand of private colleges and independent schools for funding.

The astute and truly committed organizations are continually refining their strategies for raising major gifts. As a consequence, universities, hospitals, and most nonprofits have developed systems to help organize and structure major gift fundraising. The result will provide a repeatable and predictable base for future philanthropy and institutional growth.

Moves Management™ is the most effective system for designing major gift strategies. The concept was developed by former Cornell University fundraiser

G.T. "Buck" Smith. It has since been popularized by nationally recognized disciples of the concept— the highly regarded Bill Sturtevant and David Dunlop.

Moves Management™ helps organize efforts to establish and nurture relationships with the highest-level probable donors. What is important to note is that the word "moves" does not refer to moving a donor. We're not smart enough to do that, and we wouldn't want to try to manipulate a donor.

When Buck conceived the idea, it was meant to move the staff. Buck wanted to get the staff out of the office and calling on people.

Moves Management™ provides a common language and system that fosters understanding and cooperation within an organization. It helps ensure that precious weeks and months don't slip by between contacts with important donors. It deepens relationships with donors and helps develop enduring relationships with more donors than ever before.

Ultimately it will help raise more money. A lot more.

There is very little in this Manual that is esoteric. But having the time to act consistently on what you know should be done can be quite difficult. There are so many urgencies and emergencies that demand your time and attention.

The trick is making Moves Management™ work, and work effectively in your operation. We urge you to use these concepts to enhance your philanthropic journey.

There are many beneficiaries of the success you are about to undertake. They are those who are served by your mission. And it is also your donors who will receive the satisfaction that accompanies impactful philanthropy.

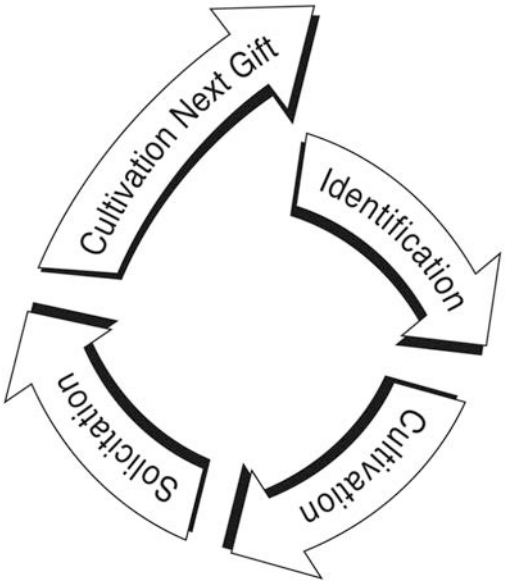
And, yes . . . you will raise a great deal more!

"See, I told you. When you use Moves Management™, the money comes pouring in."

MOVES MANAGEMENT™ DEFINED

Moves Management™ is a defined and structured process. It entails taking a series of steps (moves) with your high-level probable donors. The number of contacts and the type of moves depend on the individual donor.

You move from identification . . . to cultivation . . . to solicitation. And finally to the stewardship for the gifts that were made. You use stewardship to circle back to cultivation of the next major gift.



The emphasis is on building and maintaining relationships with your most generous donors throughout their entire philanthropic relationship with the organization. The key to success is consistency. This is the most important element Moves Management™ brings to the giving equation.

The advantages are many. Moves Management™ leads to more major gifts, more of the time. They become larger gifts. Best of all, it ensures the greatest satisfaction and joy to your donors.

Donors form multiple personal relationships with staff members and volunteers. Ultimately, Moves Management™ should lead to life-long relationships with

donors. At some point, if carried out consistently, it leads to once-in-a-lifetime donations. These are ultimate gifts.

Here is what is so special about Moves Management™. It is a system for identifying, cultivating, soliciting, and thanking donors. It does it all.

It acknowledges that major gift fundraising is highly personalized. It focuses, as Bill Sturtevant says, on the 10 percent who give 90 percent. The great majority of these are individuals.

The involvement of the top-level donors is the key to your success. *There is no more effective or consistent way to ensure that you secure the gift. Moves Management™ provides a fail-safe pathway.*

Each probable donor is almost certainly at a different stage in his or her relationship with the mission of your organization. All have different giving capabilities and interests. They respond to different peers.

You must have a specific and personalized strategy for each high-level probable donor. Moves Management™ makes this possible.

THE MOVES MANAGEMENT™ STRATEGY TEAM

The strategy team for a given probable donor is comprised of the *Moves Manager*, the *Natural Partners*, and the *Primary Player*.

The Moves Manager

The *Moves Manager* (fundraising professional) is the air traffic controller. She or he works with the *Natural Partners* and *Primary Player* to monitor the progress with a given probable donor. This ensures that timely and thoughtful contacts are made.

This job should *always* be assigned to a professional development staff member. In smaller programs, the director of development might be the *Moves Manager* for all major gift prospects. In larger programs, responsibility should be shared with campaign managers, gift planning officers, annual giving officers, and major gift officers.

The Moves Manager:

- Develops an overall goal and strategy for each probable donor.

  We will ask Mr. and Mrs. Jackson for a leadership gift of $250,000 for the children's program. The ask will be made no more than 12 months from now.

- Tracks each probable donor's relationship with the organization.

  Mr. and Mrs. Jackson had a great time at our event. They spent quality time with our CEO.

- Plans the moves for a probable donor in consultation with the *Natural Partners*.

  Our conference call with the Natural Partners went well. Board Chair Mike and trustee Alice had several suggestions on what Mr. and Mrs. Jackson will likely consider. Denise said she'd run a few ideas past them at her party. Ed agreed that Mike is the Primary Player and will need to be in on the solicitation.

- Supports the *Natural Partners* and *Primary Player*.

  We've given our Natural Partners a two-page summary of our history with Mr. and Mrs. Jackson along with a description of the program we believe they will wish to support.

- Makes sure the moves get made, records them, and reports the status to the *Natural Partners*.

  Jackie, have your note and photos gone out?

  Denise, did the Jacksons come to your party? Did you have a chance to talk to them?

  Has lunch with Mr. Smith been scheduled yet? I'll let Mike and Alice know.

- Evaluates the team's impact. Revises the moves, strategy, and goals for the probable donor as information is obtained.

  Mr. Smith didn't make Denise's party, but he and Mike had a great lunch on Tuesday. He says that what he really wants to do is set up a million-dollar trust to help us meet our long-term endowment goals. Our Gift Planning officer will schedule an appointment with him next week. Mike thinks we should try again for a big cash gift next year.

The Natural Partners

Natural Partners are the people who know the probable donor best. They can tell you what kind of contacts will be most effective.

Natural Partners provide information that help develop your strategy and assist in cultivating the probable donor. They may take part in soliciting the gift.

Keep in mind that you seek *Natural Partners* among both staff and volunteers. You will want to consider relationships that already exist and those you wish to create.

How many *Natural Partners* are appropriate? That depends upon the probable donor. You may start with only one partner, or even none.

The first call on a probable donor might be a "discovery visit" by a development staff member acting alone. This often happens when a previously unknown donor suddenly increases his or her giving. Over time, as you get to know the person, the logical *Natural Partners* and *Primary Player* present themselves.

With probable donors who are prominent in their communities or business circles, it's more likely you will start out with at least a couple of *Natural Partners*. These will often be people on your board who know the person.

You're likely to uncover other *Natural Partners* over time. Some may have close relationships to the probable donor and make good primary players. Multiple relationships are a positive factor.

Keep in mind the important job description for *Natural Partners*:

1. Help identify probable donors with whom you should be building a relationship.
2. Help develop a strategy for each probable donor with whom you are connected.
3. Assist in cultivation.
4. Assist as appropriate in solicitation.
5. Inspire with their own support.

The Primary Player(s)

The *Primary Player* is the *Natural Partner* in the best position to advance the relationship with the prospective major donor. This is the person the probable donor will have the hardest time saying "no" to— whether to an event (cultivation) or a request for a gift (solicitation).

There may be more than one *Primary Player*. But normally, it's the person with the greatest leverage with the probable donor. Different partners may fill the role of *Primary Player* over time. This happens as you build your relationship with the probable donor and encounter new *Natural Partners*.

"No, Bill—Thursday's out! How about never—is never good for you?

WHAT MAKES FOR A GOOD MOVE?

Moves cover the whole major gift process. It takes you from identification and cultivation of probable donors, to solicitation. And then to post-gift stewardship.

Most moves are cultivational. But what makes a cultivational move effective? In his book, *The Artful Journey*, Bill Sturtevant states that a move must penetrate the consciousness of the probable donor, generate vital information, and hopefully secure involvement.

Cultivation is not always easy to define. Simple entertainment is sometimes mistakenly classified as a move. For instance, having a probable donor enjoy herself at an event is great. But it does not necessarily constitute a move. Making sure that the probable donor sits next to a particular trustee (a *Natural Partner* or the *Primary Player*) is an example of what may be an effective move.

Put another way, all moves— especially cultivational moves— must have a specific and desired outcome that leads naturally to the planned next step with the probable donor. It should get you one step closer to a yes.

In envisioning the hoped-for impact of a move, be sure to think of the outcome in terms of the probable donor's relationship to the organization. For instance,

"How interested is Mr. Miller in our newest project," as opposed to, "I'm going to tell Mr. Miller all about our newest project."

The latter approach involves telling. The former employs active listening and should lead more easily to the appropriate next step. Engage the former and eschew the latter.

Measure the success of your cultivational moves. This is based on the quality and quantity of the feedback you receive from the probable donor and the agreement on a next step in the relationship.

Your job is to create a reason for getting together again. For example, you might not have a *Natural Partner* along on a visit. That's a good reason to suggest a meeting with the *Natural Partner* as the next step.

Measuring Move Outcomes

An effective way of setting objectives for cultivational moves is to determine prior to each call the best possible outcome. You then determine the minimum acceptable outcome.

If your best possible outcome is to have the probable donor agree to visit the organization next month, what is your fallback if he or she says no? What do you do next? You might counter with an invitation for them to visit later in the

year? Or you might suggest that the director would be happy to drop by with a video and some material when he or she is in town next month.

Think about what you have done. You determine in advance what is the most desirable outcome of the visit. And you decide what are you willing to accept as a minimum outcome. You can't leave the meeting without achieving one of these objectives.

Decide. Best Possible Outcome. Minimum Acceptable Outcome.

Summarizing In-person Cultivational Moves

When planning a move:

1. Identify the best possible and minimum acceptable outcomes. Determine what your next moves will be. How can you get them closer to a yes?

2. Review the key points to be covered during the call. This includes the benefits of your work that are most likely to appeal to the probable donor.

3. If there is more than one *Natural Partner* on the call, decide who will cover what. It needs to be orchestrated.

4 Anticipate the probable donor's questions, concerns, and tangential reactions. (What do you do if the probable donor wants to spend most of the time talking about fly-fishing? Or gardening? How do you use that to segue to your work, your mission, and the purpose of the meeting?)

5 Listen, listen, listen. Probe. Ask questions. Talk less— Listen more.

6 Record the outcome of your move and list what you hope to achieve in future moves.

7 Decide and schedule your next move.

"Your lead gift for the campaign is critical. It has got to establish the pattern for others. It has got to set the pace. It has got to excite the committee. It has got to unite the volunteers. It has got to ignite the board. It has got to be for more than $200."

Quality Over Quantity

Programs just getting started with major gifts fundraising would do well to consider starting with just 10 to 25 of the highest-level probable donors. This is important in the beginning. That's because it may require some trial and error to develop the least burdensome, most fluid and effective system possible.

Keeping the number small at first also helps ensure that you're thinking deeply enough and strategically about your high-level probable donors. Don't lose sight of the fact that Moves Management™ is first and foremost a way to build genuine, life-long relationships with probable donors.

The great value of Moves Management™ is that it is a way of keeping in close contact with donors. That is what builds a lasting relationship.

You will want to know what is the best way to keep track of your probable donors. Actually, a successful Moves Management™ system could be kept on index cards in an old shoebox. (We do not recommend that!) But make certain that intricate systems do not get in the way of the relationships you need to build.

Most organizations have donor tracking software, off-the-shelf or customized, which can be adapted to the Moves Management ™ process. Key elements should include determining what information and reports you need. Keep it as simple as possible. And allow for the forward planning of your Moves.

Making the Most of Strategy Meetings

You need to have strategy meetings to assess your moves. They need to be focused. Review progress and determine future action.

Make certain moves with the most important donors are as thoughtful and creative as possible. That is why development teams often limit the discussion to the 10 to 20 highest-priority probable donors for that month.

You need to be disciplined and faithful in scheduling these sessions. It is well worth the effort. Brainstorming with your colleagues about strategies produces remarkable and surprising results.

Prioritizing Probable Donors

It is important to prioritize probable donors. You do this by determining their i) willingness to give and ii) financial capacity. You go first to those who are closest to the major gift decisions at the highest levels. You do not value your men and women on the basis of how much they give. You love them all!

But fundraising is an enterprise that makes great things happen at your organization. You must prioritize.

There are many ways to prioritize. We suggest one you will find easy to use, simple, and at the same time very effective. It is an *alpha* and a *numerical* grid that ranks your probable donors.

Giving Capacity of Probable Donor (Rating Code)	**Status of Relationship** (Priority Code)	**Suggested Action**
$1 million+ **(1)**	Ready to make a major gift **(A)**	Solicit now
$500,000 - $999,999 **(2)**	Would consider major gift soon if cultivated further **(B)**	Cultivate
$250,000 - $499,999 **(3)**	Needs extensive cultivation **(C)**	Determine if a viable probable donor and begin cultivating
$100,000 - $249,999 **(4)**	Has just made a major gift **(D)**	Stewardship following the gift
$10,000 - $99,999 **(5)**	Need to qualify **(E)**	Need to learn more

Obviously, "1As" rise to the top of your list. So might any donor with a Relationship status of A or B.

How many should you have in your portfolio? It depends on the total number of high-level probable donors in the donor base, their ability to give (Giving Capacity), and how many probable donors you can adequately work with at any one time.

Do not take on more probable donors than you can effectively handle. Remember, the key is the quality of your moves, not the quantity.

As a result, the system can be simplified or made more complex as necessary. The giving capacity levels should, of course, be modified to fit a particular organization and its constituency.

There are some organizations where the Giving Capacity (the first column) might start at $500,000. Or $250,000. The Status of the Relationship (the Alpha) is not modified.

"Okay. Okay. You win. I'll sign the Pledge Card for the campaign."

HERE ARE SOME IDEAS FOR SETTING THE RIGHT AMOUNT

You are gathered around a table in the Conference Room. You, the *Natural Partner*, a few staff, and perhaps a Board member. You are determining how large a gift you should ask from some of your most promising probable donors.

Here are some principles you can use to begin the discussion and thinking. They are only guidelines. They will get you within yards, not inches. But they will get you started. We don't know why these work— but they do.

When making the evaluation, apply all six, #1 through #6 that follow. This gives you some idea of where to set the amount. If the figures are all fairly consistent, you know you're on the right track.

Real Estate (#4) can be deceiving. The value can be high. However, the property might be buried in mortgage payments.

Here are some general guidelines that will help you determine how much you might ask for over a three to five year pledge period.

1. 10 to 25 times their Annual Giving. A lot will depend on how much they stretch in their regular giving and how long they have been giving.
2. Age x Annual Income x .01
3. Net Worth x .04
4. Real Estate value (when over $500,000). Value x 4 x 5%
5. 5% to 10% of Annual Income.
6. Stockholding value x 4 x 5%

Here are some other factors to consider. Add them to the mix.

- ✔ His or her disposable income.
- ✔ Level of commitment to the mission of your organization.
- ✔ Is an advocate of the type of service you provide, even though they might not be very familiar with your organization.
- ✔ Has been giving to you annually over a long period of time.
- ✔ Has high philanthropic intent and experience.
- ✔ Is a known donor— to your organization and others.
- ✔ Has or currently serves on your Board or is an active volunteer.
- ✔ The amount of family commitments— single or widowed, or with no children, dependents, or heirs.

Getting Started

In keeping with the system advocated by David Dunlop and Bill Sturtevant, the following ten steps will get you started:

1. Identify your best probable donors. Assign each probable donor the most appropriate *Moves Manager* from your professional development staff.

2. Collect easily accessible information about the probable donor. This includes information already in your database.

   This is important to note. The emphasis is on "easily accessible." Don't let the quest for information delay you from getting out the door and making the call. Record newly uncovered information about the probable donor and revise information already in the file.

   (The very best way to gather information is to visit with the probable donor. Make the call to get the appointment. Visit. Probe. Observe. Listen.)

3. Identify *Natural Partners* for each probable donor. Use your research, discussion with volunteers, formal screenings of probable donors at board and committee meetings, and so forth. Include key *Natural Partners* from your board and other programs as appropriate.

4. Consult with the *Natural Partners* about the probable donor. The purpose of the discussion is to agree on a strategy for the contact.

5. Select a *Primary Player* from among the *Natural Partners*. This may prove to be a preliminary choice. You may have no idea at the outset who the *Primary Player* should be. But at least start looking for that person.

6. Develop an initial strategy for each probable donor. Think carefully about what you ultimately want the probable donor to do and when.

7. Plan and write down your initial moves for each probable donor. If you can come up with only one move at first, that's fine. Be sure you can articulate the purpose and desired outcome of every move. Appendix B (Planning Your Moves Management™ Initiatives) will help you guide this process.

8. Implement!

   Make the agreed upon moves and record, however briefly, the outcome of each move. Brief, yes. But make certain you have all the necessary information that will provide a successful next move.

Update *Natural Partners*. Refine your strategy and gift objectives as appropriate. Fine-tune your next move.

9. Review carefully your pool of probable donors at least once a year. Refine your long-term strategy and objectives. Plan your next round of moves for the months ahead.

10. Add or delete probable donors as appropriate. By now, you know who is likely to give. And those on your list who are probably not worth a great deal more attention.

Of interest, consider the Five Levels of Giving.

THE FIVE LEVELS

1. **Those who will give without even being asked.**
2. **Those who will give when asked.**
3. **Those who need to be motivated— then they will give.**
4. **Those who need to be motivated. They may or may not give.**
5. **The inert fifth. They are not going to make a gift no matter what you do.**

Spend your time on the first three levels, very likely 80 to 85% of your time and effort. Level 4— 10 to 15%. Spend 5% on Level 5, and then if no action, they should probably be dropped.

In Moves Management™, how low a gift do you go after?

That depends on the organization and its constituents. Use Moves Management™ if your probable donors have significant potential to make major gifts (however you define a major gift), and you believe they can give at a high level. You should not use Moves Management™ to raise modest gifts.

Instead, start with a shorter, realistic list of probable donors you can work with. You can lengthen the list over time. Your occasional "failures" at a higher level will help fill the ranks of your annual clubs or circles of sustaining giving.

Remember, it is important to look at the gift from the probable donor's perspective. It's possible that a gift of $10,000 or $25,000 may not be big at all in the eyes of some donors.

Are you seeking an annual gift? If it's one the probable donor doesn't have to give a lot of thought to (a "checkbook" gift) and can make every year, even if it is for $10,000 plus— you should probably add the person to your Moves Management™ for a stop-and-think gift.

Or are you after a major gift, one that may be as much as ten to twenty-five times the probable donor's annual gift and may require a great deal more nurturing to

close? Or are you after the ultimate gift, the once-in-a-lifetime expression of support that may be a thousand times the size of the annual gift?

These questions bear heavily on your strategy and the depth of cultivation of each probable donor. (Note the choice of the word "depth" and not "length" of cultivation. Time is only one measure of a relationship.) At the same time, of course, you also strategize sustaining gifts that require cultivation for much larger gifts that might come later.

Where do staff members responsible for annual sustaining support fit into the Moves Management™ process?

There may be modest donors now giving who would agree to a significant upgrade if properly cultivated and asked. Clearly this is fertile ground for an annual giving officer.

Annual giving officers are encouraged to take part in Moves Management™ and major gift fundraising with some probable donors.

Often the annual giving officer can begin this process immediately. It is likely to involve many of the same probable donors she or he is working with currently. Just raise the level of the ask. This can come after a little personal cultivation.

How many probable donors for a Moves Manager?

The key to success is to value quality over quantity. A *Moves Manager* who carries other responsibilities may not be able to handle more than 50 probable donors effectively, even after a good system is in place. As Moves Management™ becomes second nature, it may be possible for that number to grow.

Experience indicates that a full-time major or planned gift professional (with no other responsibilities) can manage a portfolio of from 100 to 125 probable donors. Ultimately, each development director must determine his or her own limits. Start modestly and add individuals as ambitiously as possible.

Eschew distractions so that you can focus on quality relationships. Keep in mind: it's about results, not the number of contacts.

How many moves should you plan ahead for each probable donor?

Here's a great place to save yourself some time. Reasonable Moves Management™ systems call for identifying the next four moves for each probable donor.

We suggest an alternative. This is important. Please note. Begin at the end and work backwards.

What is it that you want Mrs. Cline to do by June 30 or during the quiet phase of our campaign? Whatever that objective is for Mrs. Cline (and it may change significantly the better you get to know her), work backward from the target date. Ask the *Natural Partners*, "What is it we have to do next to begin motivating her in that direction?"

It's worth noting that not all moves are sequential. In fact, the majority may be simultaneous.

After a conference call about a probable donor, each of the *Natural Partners* may have something immediate they need to do. That might make it a little easier to plan (and write down) multiple moves. But it may still be difficult and not very useful to outline more than a few.

Our advice is not to worry. As you get to know Mrs. Cline better, more sequential moves will suggest themselves. Just be certain that you know the ideal and minimum acceptable outcome for each move you plan to make.

How many moves should you expect to make annually for each probable donor? How many moves until you can ask for the gift?

The answers depend again on the kind of gift you are asking for— annual, major, or ultimate. It is also conditioned on where you are in your relationship with the probable donor.

You should strive for at least one contact per month per probable donor. Keep in mind that you have three major ways to make a move: i) telephone; ii) personalized written communications; or iii) a personal visit. The latter has the maximum impact.

Six to eight moves may be required to close a major gift. This would imply that the probable donor should be asked for a gift within a year of being actively cultivated. But adjust the scenario to fit the donor. Each donor will be different.

Just don't wait too long to make the ask. Be careful of . . . Ready, Aim, Aim, Aim— and never Fire.

We have given you very general rules of thumb. One move per month per probable donor may be more than some can handle. This depends on how many probable donors each *Moves Manager* can effectively manage. For the probable donors with the greatest potential, many on your boards, and close friends who are very engaged in your work, contact is often weekly, if not daily.

Even your lowest priority probable donors need to hear from you at least once between solicitations. Build relationships with all of your major gift probable donors, but devote the most time and thought to the very top.

Should you first solicit gifts from your Primary Players and Natural Partners?

Okay, nobody really asks this question, but they should. Obviously, the answer is *Yes!*

The easiest way for a *Primary Player* to solicit a gift is to look a peer in the eye and say, "Carol, I want you to join us in this program but before I ask, let me tell you what Terri and I have done. We have just made a $25,000 gift to the campaign. It is one of the largest gifts we have ever made. I'm hoping you will consider doing the same. Here are the reasons . . ."

Somehow it happens. Even if your *Primary Player* doesn't give testimony to their gift, your probable donor *will* find out. If his or her friend, the *Primary Player,* isn't giving at a generous level (whether that equates to the same dollar amount being asked or not) that will affect the gift. That's why the personal giving of your *Natural Partners* and *Primary Players* is very important.

To make them effective fundraisers, they need to be asked for their gifts first. You must not take a volunteer with you to ask for a gift who hasn't made their own gift first. You do so at your own peril.

PITFALLS TO AVOID

Getting Out the Door

Here is something you should avoid like the plague. Don't think you need more and more information and data, waiting for all the stars to be properly aligned in the sky. Analysis Paralysis.

If you are not making your calls and contacts, you are on the road to failure. Get out of the office.

Your research may have turned up little. You may never have a perfect team of *Natural Partners*. You may still not have identified the *Primary Player*.

This is all the more reason for staff members and volunteers to get out the door and start building the relationship as best they can. Consider the office your enemy!

You also don't want the focus on moves and relationship building to delay your solicitation. Asking is also cultivation. This can be particularly true for corporations and some foundations, where you may have a brief, one-shot opportunity to meet with a staff member to ask for a grant.

Identifying the right *Primary Player* to make the ask is no less important for corporations and foundations. Ask yourself, "Who can best make the ask and help us start a relationship with the CEO or a key member of the corporation?"

Post-gift Stewardship

Next to getting the gift, stewardship is the most important activity in the gift process. Even the most successful nonprofits often falter in this phase.

Moves Management™ is quite clear on this point. Thoughtfully thanking donors is cultivation for the next gift. That only happens if you do an effective job of stewardship.

Try some of these tips. Some organizations keep a thank-you chart on the office wall that indicates how donors are to be thanked and by whom. There are organizations that furnish the names and addresses of every recent major donor to their trustees and staff members. They are asked to thank even those donors they do not know. No surprise— even board members who won't ask for a gift are more than willing to make thank you calls.

Donors need to feel appreciated. You must celebrate the gift.

Stewardship of donors involves far more than just thanking them. There needs to be a strategy in place that builds the relationship and leads to the next step. There needs to be a deep cultivation before the next ask.

A Final Note of Caution

Retaining high-performing development staff members is an important issue. Because many development staff members are not only *Moves Managers* but also *Natural Partners* and *Primary Players*, the impact of frequent turnover can be severe on the organization's relationship with its donors.

As you adopt a Moves Management™-driven major gifts program, staff members need to take a hard look at all they are doing. It may be important to drop or hand off time-intensive, low-return work.

Some fundraisers may be involved in doing special events, or developing brochures and other publications, or other activities that, while laudable, are no longer practical given the time, staff, and volunteer resources they require. Major Gifts and Planned Gifts— that's the pay-off.

As you implement Moves Management™, be mindful of these issues. Use the Moves system to simplify your life. And then share your experiences with your peers!

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR MAKING IT SUCCESSFUL

1. Use Moves Management™ to make your life easier. Jettison, farm out, or reduce low-return activities. Concentrate your energy and time on the highest-level probable donors. Trust that the smaller gifts will follow.

2. Keep it simple. Start with a modest, doable number of probable donors. Don't pad your *Natural Partners*— if you have only one, it's okay to say so. If you can think only one move in advance, that's fine.

   Experiment with Moves Management™. Find what works week in and week out. If the system starts to break down, streamline it. Go back to using it for fewer donors— as few perhaps as ten. Make the system work for you. You must not work for the system.

3. Even if you have dozens of donors under Moves Management™, reserve your periodic (at least monthly) planning meetings for the month's 10 or so most important donors. As one donor gives or declines to give, another takes his or her place on the top-priority list. These meetings must be true strategy sessions. Rely on your *Moves Managers* to work with the *Natural Partners* to advance the rest of your probable donors on a daily basis.

4. Keep focused on the end goal. Determine what each cultivation move should accomplish in advancing the probable donor toward a major gift. Have a minimum acceptable outcome as a fallback.

5. Observe. Be an active listener. Probe. Ask questions. Get probable donors talking about their lives. What motivates them. What is their greatest fulfillment. Use this information to revise your goals and strategies and tailor your eventual solicitation. Be certain to record information that will be important to other fundraisers, and those who someday will follow you in your job.

6. Work with other internal programs in the organization to build the relationship with the probable donor. This will make certain that the best possible proposal is placed before him or her. Often, proposals will be multiprogram requests that benefit everyone.

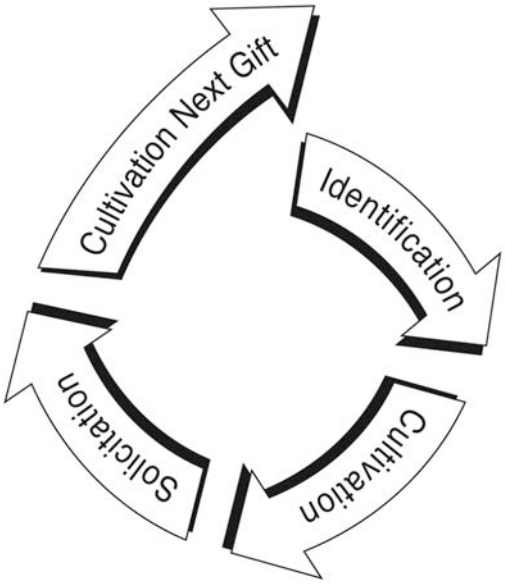
7. Don't squander your donor relationships for a quick return. Each move should advance the probable donor toward the near-term goal. It should also advance the probable donor's life-long relationship with the cause.

8. Don't let the system get in your way. Make it work for you.

Get out the door. Cultivate. Ask for the gift. If you spend too much time in the office, you are a traitor to the cause.

A Checklist for Moving Probable Donors to "Yes"

A relationship with a probable donor has four phases—



1 identification
2 cultivation
3 solicitation
4 stewardship

A checklist for each phase follows.

1. *Identification*

Goal: identify a new probable donor and gather as much easily accessed information about the probable donor as possible. Meet the probable donor and gauge his or her interest in the organization.

- ✔ Assemble basic information and identify the probable donor's current relationship with the organization.
- ✔ Identify *Natural Partners* and assemble their knowledge about the probable donor.
- ✔ Select the *Primary Player*. Bear in mind that the role may be played by different partners over time as the relationship with the probable donor matures.
- ✔ Visit the probable donor to introduce the mission and assess the probable donor's interest.

- ✔ Preliminarily, set the asking objective for the probable donor. It is based on his or her interests and capacity. Plan the next move or moves.

Appendix C, Probable Donor Identification, may prove of value in the process of identification and qualification.

2. *Cultivation*

Goal: increase the probable donor's understanding of, involvement in, and passion for the mission so that a gift solicitation is the next logical step.

- ✔ Engage the probable donor emotionally through site visits, peer encouragement, and bonding with staff members or with particular projects.
- ✔ Ensure that the probable donor has a solid understanding of the specific project or campaign for which you intend to solicit.
- ✔ Confirm that the *Primary Player* has made his or her own financial commitment.
- ✔ Verify that the moves team has done its homework and has confidence in the nature and size of the request.

3. *Solicitation*

Goal: obtain the gift you currently need. Keep in mind that the long-term relationship may influence the immediate request.

- ✔ Collaborate with the *Primary Player* and other *Natural Partners* to develop a solicitation strategy. This should include the appropriate setting and place, the roles each partner will play, and the amount you are going to ask for.
- ✔ Think about the amount with the minimum acceptable gift kept in mind. Consider the acceptable timing of the gift (multiyear?) and the possible naming opportunities. What are the questions or concerns the probable donor might raise? Review the strategy before you ask.
- ✔ Ask the probable donor, in person, to consider a gift of a specific amount for a specific purpose.
- ✔ Note how the probable donor reacts. Provide the probable donor with follow-up materials. This should include a formal proposal or answers to questions, as appropriate.
- ✔ Solicit endorsements or encouragement from the *Natural Partners* or influential people outside the moves team.

The probable donor makes the gift, delays, or declines. You develop a strategy accordingly.

4. *Post-gift Stewardship*

Goal: A positive giving experience is the single best cultivation for the next gift. You must make the donor feel as good as possible about having made a donation and what the gift has accomplished.

Jerry Panas' often-used concept of thanking a donor seven times captures the spirit of what staff members and volunteers need to do. Use thank-you letters, public recognition, little gifts, regular communications, and trips to see the places

and people the donor is supporting. This phase naturally leads back to formal cultivation— preparing the probable donor for the next solicitation.

What if the probable donor declines to make the gift? It does happen!

The *Moves Manager* and *Natural Partners* need to determine the new status of the probable donor. Should the probable donor be removed from the list, remain a high priority, or move to the "much more cultivation" or "inactive" lists?

- ✔ Acknowledge the gift. All appropriate organization people should thank the donor. Board members, also.
- ✔ If the donor finds it acceptable, publicly recognize and publicize the naming opportunity.
- ✔ Provide the donor follow-up reports on what his or her gift is accomplishing.
- ✔ Identify areas in which the relationship with the probable donor can be broadened or strengthened.
- ✔ Develop a new cultivation strategy, identifying the next fundraising goal for the probable donor.

At this point, the probable donor returns to the cultivation stage.

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Moves Mangement™ is a registered trademark of the Institute for Charitable Giving.

Our thanks to The Nature Conservancy and its Development Learning Center for developing a workbook that reflected the principles we teach at our Institute for Charitable Giving seminars. Their work served as a prototype as well as an inspiration for this Manual.

APPENDIX A
PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

Fundraising is a critically important responsibility of trustees and other volunteers associated with your organization. Board members hold in trust the future of your organization. They cannot abdicate their duty to fundraising.

There is a fail-proof way to work most effectively with current and probable donors. You can ensure you are responsive to the interests of these friends and supporters. The system we introduce you to focuses your fundraising activity to what will produce the highest return. The fundraising system that ensures your success is known as Moves Management™.

- WHAT IS MOVES MANAGEMENT™?

Moves Management™ is a system for building deep, life-long relationships with prospective donors. If properly and faithfully pursued, it is fail-proof. You will be successful.

Each probable donor has a *Moves Manager*. This is a member of your development staff who manages and tracks the relationship and serves as an advocate for the probable donor.

The *Moves Manager* also helps to identify *Natural Partners*. These are the people who can advance the relationship with the probable donor.

Finally, the *Moves Manager* and the *Natural Partners* identify a *Primary Player*. This is the person who will most likely get a positive response from the probable donor. This person will get a "yes"— whether to an invitation to an event or a request for a large gift.

As with *Natural Partners*, the *Primary Player* could be a staff person or a trustee or other volunteer.

- WHAT IS A "MOVE?"

A "move" is almost anything that helps develop the relationship between a prospective donor and the organization. It can be accomplished by a telephone call, personalized written communication, or personal visit. A move is not intended to manipulate the donor. Instead, it offers a donor an opportunity to better appreciate the work, outreach, and mission of your organization.

Some moves are more effective than others. For instance, having a probable donor enjoy himself or herself at one of your events is desirable and of value— but it usually does not constitute a move. Making sure the probable donor sits next to a particular trustee (a *Natural Partner* or the *Primary Player*), who offers to

accompany the probable donor to a visit, is likely an effective move. Put another way, a move should be strategic.

There should be a specific, desired outcome that leads naturally to the planned next step with the probable donor.

- BEST AND WORST CASES

Prior to contacting a prospective major donor, it is important to collaborate with the staff to determine the best possible outcome and the minimum acceptable outcome. For example, the best possible outcome may be to have the probable donor agree to tour a facility.

But what will you do if the answer is no or there is a delay? Be prepared to suggest an alternative. Suggest, for instance, having someone visit the probable donor's home or office to share more information and determine the reason for the delay.

The same is true of a request for a gift. A probable donor may not be able to give you the full amount of your request this year but might consider a gift of equal size stretched over several years. Or there may be a planned gift or gift of real estate to supplement or substitute for an outright cash gift.

- IDENTIFYING PROBABLE DONORS

It is the job of a trustee or key volunteer to help identify members of your community and friends of the institution who could become potential donors or major donors. Many of the largest gifts come from donors who do not have a great deal of information or identification about the organization until a trusted friend introduced them to the work, service, and mission.

- THINK SMALL

Big, high-profile events are appropriate for gaining short-term publicity or celebrating a successful project. They usually are, however, time-intensive and not often cost-productive. Typically they are not very effective for major gifts fundraising.

Instead, think of hosting a breakfast, lunch, or dinner with 10 or fewer probable donors. This may be the biggest event you would need to meet your fundraising goals.

Your objective is to make friends for the organization. You can do this most effectively in small, intimate gatherings.

- WHEN TO ASK

Sometimes it is appropriate to ask for a major gift on the first visit. There are other times when the ideal ask might take two or more years down the road.

The ask is where science ends and art begins. This is also where Moves Management™ proves its worth.

The right timing will often reveal itself. But even if it does not (or if you are faced with a campaign or project deadline that requires you to ask *now*), the effort you have put into building the relationship greatly increases the odds of the probable donor making a significant gift.

It might not be the maximum gift you hoped for, but it's a beginning. Showing the proper appreciation and celebrating the gift is the first step in securing another gift. A larger gift!

- WHAT TO ASK FOR

Fundraising is most successful when it is *donor-driven*. It is critical that you determine the probable donor's interests and coordinate closely with other appropriate representatives in the organization. You can determine whether they have an existing relationship with the probable donor or not. Staff members will ensure you have the necessary information and explain how to use it.

Some donors wish to give only to one project or program at a time. Others may be receptive to a coordinated, multiprogram request.

It is essential that you not overlook such an opportunity. A multiprogram request might not only increase the size of the donor's gift but also build stronger, multiple relationships between your organization and the donor.

There are times your organization may suggest you ask for undesignated gifts— or to give to a specific project. Keep in mind— the donor rules. They will decide where they want the gift to go.

- HOW TO ASK

The most effective way to ask is for the asker to make their own gift first. It is convincing to say, "Mary, I have just made a $20,000 gift, and I hope you will also consider a $20,000 gift for the following reasons . . ."

It is not important that the gift and your probable donor's gift be the same amount. Rather, they should represent the same level of commitment based on the respective abilities to give. A gift of $1,000 from a trustee who is a university professor may be as compelling and sacrificial as a gift of $1 million from a trustee who is a successful entrepreneur.

The unalterable rule is that the person who asks for the gift must have made their own gift. And what is important is that it be a stretch gift. The asker needs to talk about the gift and why they made it.

- FOLLOWING UP

Whether the probable donor says yes or no, what happens next is critical. Some otherwise excellent development offices do a poor job of following up and continuing to cultivate donors and probable donors after they have made the gift.

Many donors see their gifts as investments and want to know what the return is on their investment. They will ask, "What was done with my money?"

You want to make certain that the organization and friends who are associated with the donor have shown the proper appreciation. "Have I seen the place or program I have given to? Have I heard from the manager of the program that benefited from my gift?"

Put yourself in the donor's shoes when determining the proper way to express gratitude and deepen the relationship. By thanking donors and keeping them fully informed, you are continuing a dialogue that will lead to future gifts.

- BUILDING RELATIONSHIPS

You are passionate about the organization you serve and the people you help along the way. You make great things happen.

Fundraising is really about building quality relationships with donors. You are essential to the vigor and outreach of the organization. You are responsible for the organization's extended hand to change lives and save lives.

Your work is critically important and exciting. The work you do, and your fundraising, is an invitation to others to participate in a great cause. The more you allow your donors and probable donors to experience firsthand your passion and commitment, the more joy and satisfaction they gain from their involvement.

Moves Management™ is simply a system for making certain you remain thoughtful, reliable, and consistent in your relationships with donors and probable donors. The successful funding of your mission depends on building life-long relationships and creating an ever-widening community of dedicated friends.

John R. Mott is a renowned missionary of the early 1900s. He wrote, "Blessed are the fundraisers, for in heaven, they shall stand on the right hand of the martyrs."

The solicitation process is doubly blessed. You the asker are indeed blessed for your participation and commitment. And those who give are blessed for their support of a great cause.

APPENDIX B
PLANNING YOUR MOVES MANAGEMENT™ INITIATIVES: BUILDING INTEREST, EXTENDING INVITATIONS, AND GENERATING INVOLVEMENT

So, what exactly are "moves"? The objective is to move you and your probable donors up the pyramid of awareness. You wish to create expressions of commitment to achieve satisfying, rewarding, and productive philanthropic relationships. There are two basic activities you employ to do this:

1. ***Background activities*** These are activities planned and executed to reach many people at one time with a cultivation activity. If attended by multiple probable donors for whom you are the *Moves Manager*, you should plan your contacts and the logistics (e.g., seating arrangements) with great care.

   This might include a talk by a staffer or volunteer from your organization. Or it could be an event honoring someone who has performed outstanding service, or perhaps just a reception sponsored by your organization.

2. ***Foreground activities*** These activities are initiatives that you plan and execute with one donor in mind (or a "donor-unit," such as a married couple). For instance, you might arrange a tour of a your organization's

facility or invite a donor to help in a meaningful part of the work. Anything that advances your donor through a cycle of increasing emotional attachment and satisfaction is a valid and useful foreground activity.

Most experienced practitioners of Moves Management™ find they can plan at least three or four "moves" or initiatives to increase the donor's current enthusiasm and dedication to the organization. But they often find they are revising those plans as they get to know donors and build their relationships.

Much like any other relationship, some spontaneity (even if it is planned!) is good and should be encouraged. Churchill once said that it took him a long time and great effort to plan an effective spontaneous visit.

What follows is the moves planning system on which Moves Management™ software is based. If you do not use software but prefer doing the work manually, remember to coordinate the due dates with your calendar as a reminder of your objectives.

How to Use the Initiative Planning Form

Choose an activity and a *Natural Partner* who advances your position with the donor for whom you are planning a visit. It should be something that fits with the donor's previous experience and your understanding of the donor's preferences and traits.

Plan a date when this activity should happen. Record what your minimal expectations are for optimum results. You may wish just to create enough interest in your organization that your donor wishes to learn more. Then, prepare a short statement about what the best possible outcome of this activity could be.

A spontaneous gift is probably not the best outcome you could want. Spontaneous gifts (those not asked for or carefully cultivated) tend to be small and not very satisfying for the donor or your organization.

It is usually best to plan at least three or four activities ahead of the current move, but you must also stay very flexible and respond to what you learn about your donor along the way. Finally, after each initiative is completed, note the results you have achieved.

What follows is an Initiative Planning Form you are encouraged to use for recording all of your activities. If you use the Form, you are assured of an effective cultivation process.

But feel free to develop your own form for recording Moves. Whatever works for you. The important factor is that you track your activities.

MOVES MANAGEMENT™ INITIATIVE PLANNING FORM

Probable Donor: _____
Moves Manager: _____

Initiative One Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

Initiative Two Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

Initiative Three Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

Initiative Four Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

INITIATIVE PLANNING FORM (continued)

Initiative Five Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

Initiative Six Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

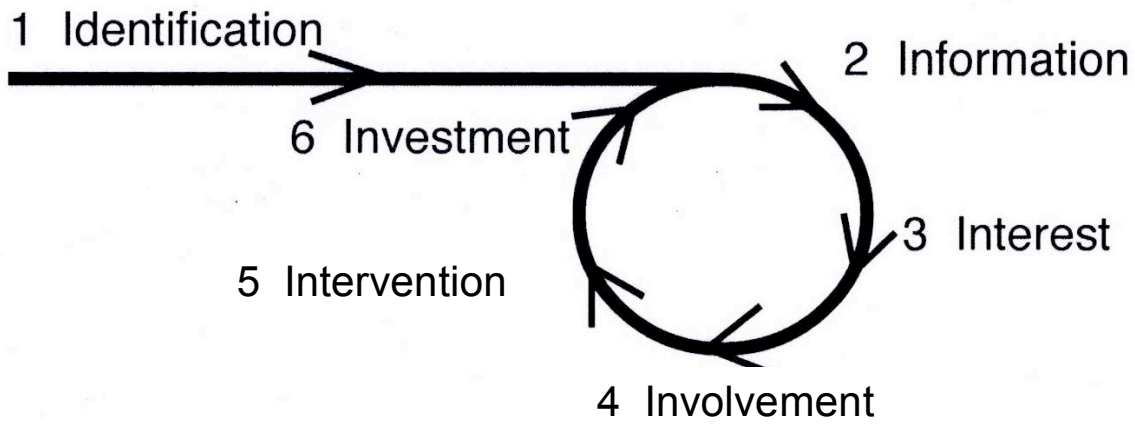
Initiative Seven Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

Initiative Eight Activity & Natural Partner:	
Due Date:	Minimum Acceptable Result:
Result Desired:	
Results Achieved:	

APPENDIX C
PROBABLE DONOR IDENTIFICATION

The first step in the Moves Management™ process is identifying donors and friends you believe will become your best probable major gift donors. Probable donors are people who i) have the ***ability*** to make a large gift, ii) can be ***motivated*** to do so because of their interest in your organization's work, and iii) can be asked in a compelling way to give.

We call this the I-Cycle. It begins with Identification. Then the Is continue:



This is why Moves Management™ is so effective. It ensures you touch every I.

We provide two tools you can use to identify probable donors:

a. the PEG form was created and published by the Institute for Charitable Giving. It was developed and designed by Bill Sturtevant and Jerry Panas. This remarkable form helps you establish a useful rating of

ability to make a large gift (based on financial capacity) and ***motivation*** to make a large gift (based on involvement in the organization or close relationship with a volunteer); and,

b. a ***Donor Nomination Form*** which is used by a number of charitable organizations. This seeks and rates prospective donors from among those involved in the organization, particularly leaders.

Using these two tools, you can effectively qualify a number of possible donors as ***probable donors***. The number of probable donors that will be comfortable and manageable to begin cultivating in a major gifts philanthropic relationship varies depending on your experience and your time constraints.

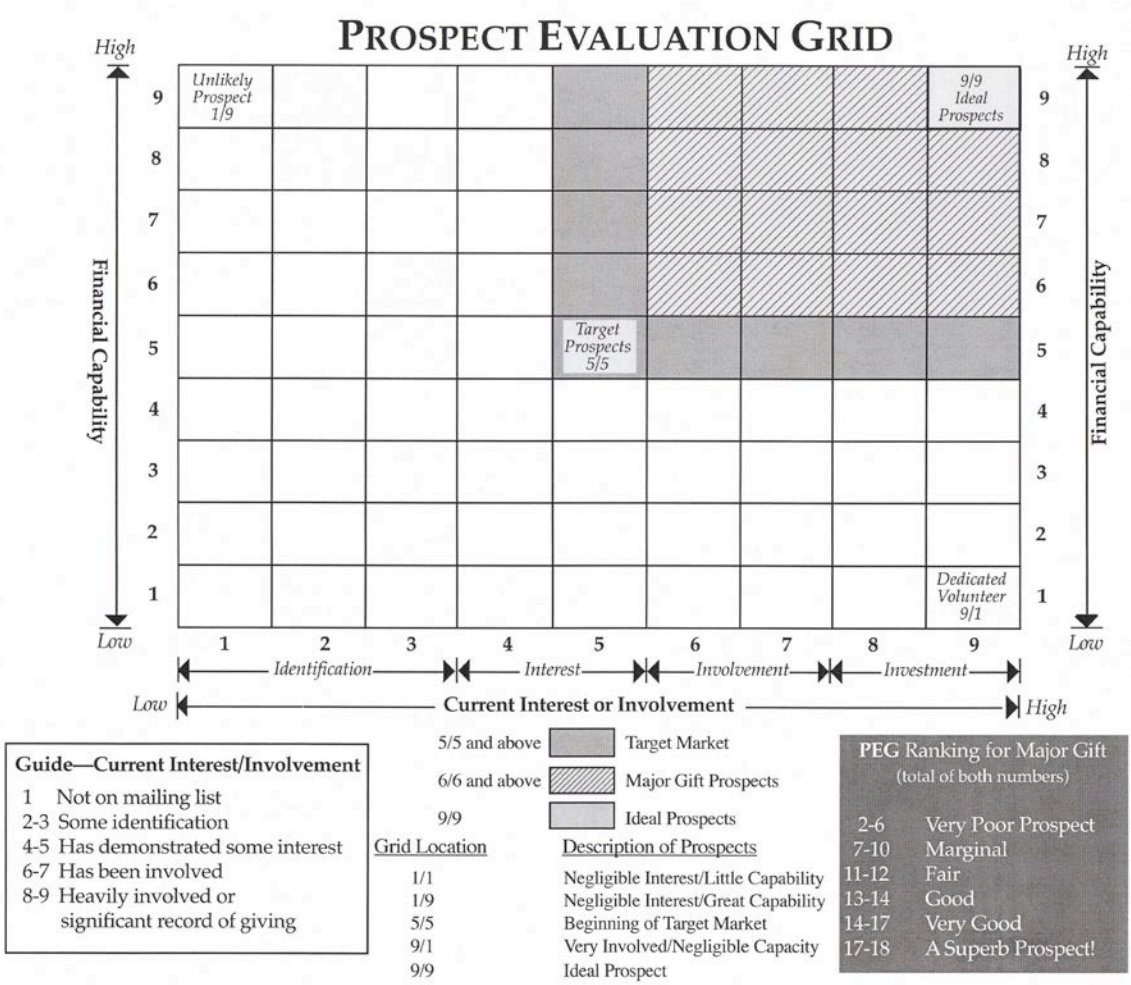
Start with five (5) qualified probable donors (i.e., people who have the ability, motivation, and to whom you can give the opportunity to give). It is a good place to begin. *Natural Partners* (see below) should focus at first on the quality of relationships, not quantity.

It is not unusual for a *Moves Manager*— a staff person— to eventually manage more than a hundred (100) major gift probable donors and donors. Perhaps as many as 125, and certainly no more than 150 at the very most. This is true if the staff person has only the responsibility of contacting and calling on major donors.

One of the most important elements of the identification process is to designate *Natural Partners* for each probable donor. *Natural Partners* are people who are in your probable donors' social, professional, and other networks. *Natural Partners* help advance the probable donor's level of gift-commitment to your organization.

The best or most effective *Natural Partner* is the *Primary Player*. He or she must be an active partner with the *Moves Manager* in seeking major gifts. Identification and involvement of *Natural Partners* is a constant and key success factor in pursuing major gifts.

"As I told you before when I brought you here— they're not using Moves Management™, so they decided to take a more creative approach in soliciting a gift."



HOW TO USE THE PEG FORM

Use the attributes on the ***Donor Nomination Form***, or a form of your own, with nine (9) being the best and highest and one (1) being the least possible or lowest. For each probable donor, use the information you have (and verified, if possible) to assign a PEG score for both financial capacity and involvement in your organization or motivation to make a gift.

PEG is not an exact process. The system is most valuable as a way to prioritize your major gifts activities— to focus on the best probable donors in the time you have available for this work.

Donor Nomination Form

Possible Donor's Name:	
Address:	Email:
City, State, ZIP:	
Telephone 1:	Telephone 2 (O Fax):
Business Name:	Occupation/Title:
Address:	
City, State, ZIP:	
Telephone 1:	Telephone 2 (O Fax):
Spouse Name:	Spouse Business:
Occupation/Title:	Telephone:

AMO Evaluation (*. . . to make a gift, on a scale of one to nine, nine is tops*)

	Ability		Motivation
9	Principal Gift Donor *($1,000,000 or more)*	9	Already motivated & strongly affiliated
8	Advanced Gift prospect *($500,000 or more)*	8	Enthusiastic, needs just a little cultivation
7	Special Gift prospect *($100,000 or more)*	7	Supportive & loyal, some attention needed
6	Major Gift prospect *($50,000 or more)*	6	Positive but not close to your organization
5	Helpful Gift prospect *(less than $50,000)*	5	Needs full cultivation to understand goals

	Opportunity
9	Very available, would welcome involvement
8	Usually available, would be positive
7	I can get through, s/he will take my calls
6	Here much of the time, I can contact
5	Here seasonally, I can contact

AMO total score

Any special situations? _____

Who do you believe would be the best staff and volunteer *Natural Partners*? _____

_____

Other relevant information: (*contacts related to us, etc.*): _____

_____

_____

Nominator's Name: _____

Best contact phone: _____ E-mail: _____

INFORMATION GATHERING

Gathering information is important for one very critical reason: *it ensures that you build and nurture the best philanthropic relationship possible with your major gift donors and probable donors.*

These are of three categories of information related to:

a. the ***ability*** of your probable donors to make gifts— and at what level. This is particularly useful when planning your cultivation activities. It allows you to begin the process of making certain the information is aimed at gift strategies and techniques that will satisfy and serve the donor in a meaningful and joyful way;

b. the ***motivation,*** based on your probable donor's interests and preferences that will make a relationship with your organization satisfying and rewarding. It will ensure your proposal for a gift is winsome and winning; and,

c. the ***opportunity*** comprised of the best gift proposal you can make and the best solicitors you can choose. This is based on what you know about the probable donor rather than what you believe or guess.

The pages that follow will guide you in gathering the information you need to cultivate productive philanthropic relationships and to solicit major gifts.

Ultimate Gift Donor Information	
Name:	Spouse:
Mail Address: O Business O Home O Other	
Other Address: O Business O Home O Other	
Phone 1: O Business O Home O Cell O Fax	Phone 2: O Business O Home O Cell O Fax
Phone 3: O Business O Home O Cell O Fax	Phone 4: O Business O Home O Cell O Fax
Phone 5: O Business O Home O Cell O Fax	Phone 6: O Business O Home O Cell O Fax
Email:	Email:
Occupation:	Enterprise:
Business website:	Personal website:
Salutation:	Salutation with spouse:
Birthday: Spouse Birthday:	ID/Status Code:
Moves Manager:	Moves Manager's Phone:

Financial Information			
Status: A Solicit B Some Cultivation C Extensive Cultivation D Stewardship E Qualify			
PEG Score:	*Amount*	*Date*	*Information*
Most Recent Gift	$		
Biggest Gift	$		
Cumulative Gifts	$	# of Years:	

Information You Have Gathered

Financial Ability & Capacity	

Interest in Us	***Motivation and Interest Information***

Information You Have Gathered *(continued)*

Major Interests	Motivation and Interest Information

Significant Emotional Events	Motivation and Interest Information

Corporate and Foundation Profile Information

Record information related to foundations or corporations with which the probable donor is involved

Name:

Giving Priorities	

Giving Summary	

Corporate/Foundation Executive	Title

Ticker Symbol(s)

Corporate and Foundation Profile Information *(continued)*

Board Members	*Center of Influence A**	*Center of Influence B**

*Natural partners who might influence the identified board members on your behalf.

Centers of Influence

Center of Influence	***Name***	***Telephone***
Accountant		
Banker/Trust Officer 1		
Banker/Trust Officer 2		
Clergy		
Doctor 1		
Doctor 2		
Financial Planner		

Center of Influence	Name	Telephone
Investment Manager		
Lawyer 1		
Lawyer 2		
Life Insurance Professional		
Other 1		
Other 2		
Other 3		

Natural Partners	Telephone
Primary:	
Secondary 1:	
Secondary 2:	
Secondary 3:	
Secondary 4:	
Secondary 5:	
Secondary 6:	
Secondary 7:	

Personal Achievements and Involvement			
	Year		Year
College/Univ 1:		College/Univ 2:	
Graduate/Professional School:		Military Service:	
Community Organization 1:		Community Organization 2:	
Community Organization 3:		Community Organization 4:	
Our Award:		Award 1:	
Award 2:		Award 3:	
Political Affiliation:		Publications:	
Professional Society 1:		Professional Society 1:	
Other 1:		Other 2:	
Other 3:		Other 4:	

Summary of History with Your Organization

Please number, date, and initial all additions to this record.

Donor Name:	Date of First Entry:

Donor Recognition

	Description of Recognition	*Gift Amount*	*Site*	*Placement at Site*
Gift One		$		
Gift Two		$		
Gift Three		$		
Gift Four		$		
Gift Five		$		
Gift Six		$		
Gift Seven		$		
Gift Eight		$		
Gift Nine		$		
Gift Ten		$		

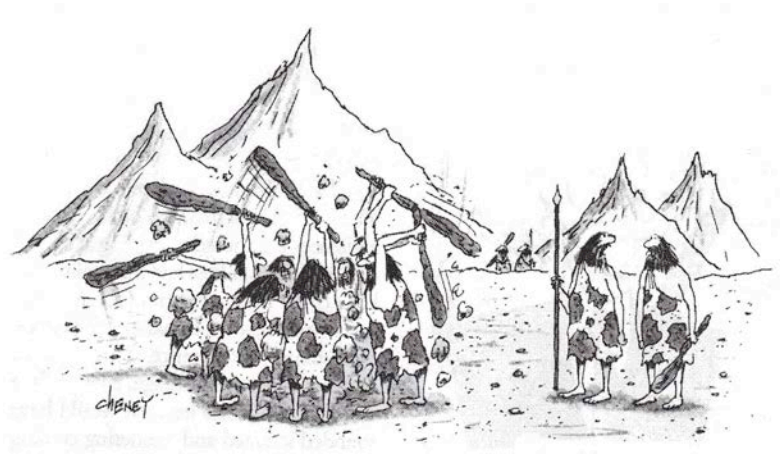
YOU ARE ON YOUR WAY TO SUCCESS

Moves Management™ is simply a system for making sure you remain thoughtful, reliable, and consistent in your relationships with donors and probable donors. The success of your work depends on building life-long relationships and creating an ever-widening community of committed friends.

What follows is an instrument called Peak Performance. It was developed by Jerry Panas and Bill Sturtevant for the Institute for Charitable Giving.

If you score 90 and above, you are well on your way to success. That is the score you should aspire to.

Finally, keep in mind that your job is to get the largest gift possible, in the shortest amount of time, to the greatest joy of the donor. If you faithfully follow the Moves Management™ process, you are on your way to success.



"They're experimenting with a new way to solicit a gift.
If that doesn't work, they're going to try Moves Management™."

INSERT PAGE ONE OF PEAK PERFORMANCE HERE

INSERT PAGE TWO OF PEAK PERFORMANCE HERE

APPENDIX D
THE MASTER SPEAKS

There is no activity in fundraising that has had a greater impact in the field than the concept of Moves Management™. It has left an indelible mark on philanthropy.

It is practiced in virtually every college and university that is successful in its fundraising. And by most hospitals and medical centers. And museums, all fields of the arts, and social agencies.

A young development officer at Cornell University conceived the idea. He wanted to add structure to major gift fundraising. And he wanted to "move" staff people— get them out of the office, making calls and contacts.

That young development officer later became president of three colleges. His name is G.T. Smith— known by everyone as Buck.

His friend and colleague at Cornell was David Dunlop. Dave became the great apostle of Moves. A compelling speaker, he has given thousands (yes, thousands) of lectures on the subject. It is Dave Dunlop's contribution that the concept spread nationally. Indeed, internationally.

The baton was passed from David to William T. Sturtevant. Bill is a powerful speaker and an author of note (*The Artful Journey*). No single person has done more to spread the gospel of Moves Management™ than Bill Sturtevant.

Buck Smith. Dave Dunlop. Bill Sturtevant. The three outstanding Ambassadors of the concept. And no organization has done more to further the cause than the Institute for Charitable Giving. The Institute owns the name.

What follows are two papers written by Dave Dunlop. Both are reprinted from CASE *CURRENTS*. One was written in 1987, the other in 1990. They are classic . . . and as current as tomorrow.

"That's truly an impressive finish to your presentation, Jerry — but I still don't believe I'd be interested in making a gift."

Thirty Years of Fund Raising

Master fund raiser David Dunlop tells what he's learned about the staff's role in dealing with donors.

By David Dunlop with Ellen Ryan

You might think we at Cornell, like Harvard and Stanford, have somany prospects of such financial capacity that if we fail with one major donor, we can go on to the next and the next and the next and not worry about it.

I doubt this is true anywhere, but it certainly isn't at institutions with small constituencies and large needs. Or thosewith large constituencies and a small staff. After all, Cornell's major gifts program started in 1974 with just a secretary and me. As our efforts grew, we formed the concepts and techniques that worked into a proven system. The concepts that now guide the work of our 27 principal, major, and special gifts staff members are even more important for the one- or two-person shop with far fewer prospects.

In three decades of development work at Cornell, I've learned from true experts and compiled a few techniques of my own for organizing a staff to raise major gifts. As cliched as it sounds, the most effective staff is the one that works as a team. Here are my thoughts on how to use both talent and equipment to achieve that goal.

Movers And Managers

Perhaps the most important concept I've come across to foster success with major gifts is the moves concept. G.T. (Buck) Smith, former president of Chapman College, developed this back in the early '70s, and I put it to use for the first time here.

The moves concept focuses major gift fund raising on changing people's attitudes so they want to give. To do this, we take a series of initiatives or moves to develop each prospect's awareness of, knowledge of, interest in, involvement with, and commitment to the institution and its mission.

Under this concept, the best contacts with potential givers are the people who already play a natural part in the givers' relationship with your institution. For example, rather than send out a staff member with a case statement, it's better to work through a faculty member, trustee, or other volunteer who knows the person. The friend who provides the best direct link with a prospective giver Buck called the prime, and the lesser but still helpful links he called secondaries. (These terms may help staff define roles, but volunteers usually see themselves as helping you with their friends.)

A development officer probably isn't the first person the donor wants to see. That's why, especially early on, your staff's job is to identify the natural

partners, build on their relationships, and create a string of initiatives that benefit both giver and institution.

Identifying the natural partners is like learning who your friends' friends are. You keep expanding that network for each person. The painstaking process begins in your office with a staff, or moves, manager.

This person's first job is to read the correspondence and memos about a particular prospect. Next, the moves manager talks to people close to home--faculty, staff, students, and classmates--who know the prospect and can identify others in touch with him or her who might be able to help.

The manager works outward, talking about the prospect and sensing who might be both able and willing to help advance that relationship. Having one staff person manage this brings discipline and organization to the process. After all, these moves are investments of your most important talent--your president, senior executive and academic staff, and trustees and other leading volunteers. You don't want to waste such resources on efforts that are premature or poorly planned.

The Value of Constant Contact

If we're not in the hearts and minds of prospective givers every few weeks, other causes they favor will take over more of their attention. That's why we at Cornell have established a six-step procedure for the moves manager (and primes and secondaries) to use at least once a month with every prospect.

The six steps are these: (1) Review the prospect's relationship with your institution, (2) plan the most beneficial next moves, (3) coordinate and check those plans with the other people involved with that prospect, (4) execute what transpired, (5) evaluate what transpired, and (6) report to the primes and secondaries.

These steps are not a move in themselves. Rather, they provide the discipline through which the appropriate people make the moves. And such steps don't necessarily assume success. Success depends on the quality, frequency, and continuity of these moves, which in turn grow out of the character and integrity of your people. If you choose and train your staff well, and they're wholeheartedly committed, quality will show in the work they do.

That's a long-term view, of course. You can't expect the major gifts to come quickly. Our experience runs the full gamut: sometimes we've received a wonderfully large gift after just a few months; others never come even after many years. Si Seymour, our first consultant and author of the classic _Designs for Fund Raising,_ used to say that if you want alfalfa, you can raise several crops a year. But if you want oaks, it'll take a little longer. Be prepared to make the investment required for the type of gift you seek.

If you're new to the moves concept, I suggest you apply these ideas to a small number of donors at first--two or three, maybe five or 10. Work through the system on a small scale first to get a feel for it. Once you've got it on track, then try it with more prospects.

The Tracking System

A good tracking system is your basic tool to manage, coordinate, communicate, and stimulate major fund-raising activity. It identifies whom you're dealing with--not only prospects but also primes, secondaries, and staff managers. It records your targets, what you hope for the next gift, what you want it for, and how you plan to work toward it. Most important, it tells how your plans fit in with recent history. It records previous plans and events so you can see why you did or didn't make certain moves.

The tracking system can also help you balance the attention you and your staff gives to prospects. It's easy to undertake a lot of initiatives with the people with

whom you are most comfortable. But you're likely to give less attention to other prospects, especially new ones still at the identification orinformation stage rather than the involvement and commitment stage. Your tracking system reminds you where to put fresh energy.

Here's an example of how our system works. Let's say our prime connection with a particular family is our dean of liberal arts. At least once a month, we send the dean a paper report on the history of our relationship with the prospect family. This information is also in the computer system, to which all our development offices have access. But paper reports have certain advantages.

For one thing, the dean can mark his or her comments and suggestions right on the page and send it back through campus mail. That makes it easy to participate and more likely that he or she will. The report is also a physical reminder of what others in the institution are doing with the prospects. That good old competitive spirit comes in and the dean says, "maybe I should get going, too, and do more." And it offers the opportunity to say, "Hey, that's not appropriate; you shouldn't do that and here's why."

One concern about prospect tracking is confidentiality. I suggest you don't send these reports to primes and secondaries off campus. Instead, have your moves manager consult with these helpers by phone, mail, and personal visits. If you appear too systematic to volunteers, they'll feel manipulated. Tracking is not manipulation; it's just managing initiatives. But if it feels like manipulation, it'll have a negative effect. We don't need that, especially when we can avoid it with just a letter or phone call.

For both the staff and others on campus, a good tracking system expresses ideas in plain English. That's important because you're recording all the subtleties of the process from awareness to commitment. Codes just don't convey the nuances you need here.

By the way, in my view, using quantitative tracking as a management tool can be destructive. It creates pressure for initiatives, but not necessarily good ones. If you as the boss start to evaluate staff members by how many moves they make, how many miles they travel, how many proposals they send, your staff may then start suspending judgment in favor of generating whatever numbers you seem to want. They start to say, in essence, "You want me to visit? I'll go out and visit. I'll visit as many times as you want. It may not be appropriate, I may not be the one the donors want to see, but I'll visit."

I recommend evaluating members of your staff not by the numbers but by what's happening in their relationships. To do this you have to be sensitive to how they're building each prospect's awareness, knowledge, interest, involvement, and commitment. A review of the tracking system reports, the correspondence, and personal encounters with the prospects will give you a feel forthe officer's progress.

Dollar signs alone can be deceptive. After all, it might seem that an officer is doing a fabulous job when a super gift comes in, but the feelings that caused the giver to make that gift may have been nurtured for three, 10, or 20 years and by other people. Conversely, another staff person may be doing superb work at fostering the feelings that will prompt many large gifts, but not for another year...

LOOK TO THE NEEDS OF THE DONOR

G.T. (Buck) Smith, a nationally recognized fund raiser (now president of Chapman College), once pointed out that the heart of business is changing people's views of the institution from "they" and "them" to "we" and "us." Once that change occurs, you'll get not only financial commitments, but personal, moral, and spiritual support as well.

So how do we change the "them" perspective to an "us" perspective? As I look at people who have made ultimate gifts, here and elsewhere, I've noticed that the specific experiences they've had leading up to those commitments vary widely. But the types of experiences are identical. All these givers had experiences withthe institution--and with the projects they've supported--that developed their:

* awareness,
* knowledge,
* interest,
* involvement,
* sense of commitment, and
* expressions of commitment.

If this process is common to all past givers of major gifts, then it's obvious that we should try to duplicate these sorts of experiences for prospective givers. Thus, major gift fund raising comes down to the business of enhancing the prospect's relationship with the institution. Ideally, we'll encourage a series of experiences that will lead prospects through these various stages to the point of feeling, and expressing, commitment.

Let's look more closely at the idea of tracking the progress of a relationship. The typical way fund raisers measure progress is to count up the numbers of dollars and donors they've acquired in a given year. At the top giving levels, though, that's not an accurate measure. These gifts are based not on what you did last year, but on what's happened over the last 25 or 30 years. So if you measure the dollars that happen to flow in during, say, 1987, you're not looking at the process. You're just totaling the cash register tape at the end of the process. Likewise, if you count the numbers of givers based on when they happened to become givers, as opposed to looking at those who are developing relationships, you're not measuring the thing that really matters.

Our object, then, is to track not dollars but involvement. Our means of measurement is the number and type of contacts each of our top prospects has with an institution. If we can monitor their experiences--and initiate additional experiences of the right sort at the right time--we can deepen that person's relationship with the institution. And the deeper that relationship, the more likely that person will eventually consider our institution for an ultimate gift.

(One point worth noting: Like all models, this one is less complex on paper than it is in real life. Ideally, we'd be able to work systematically to develop awareness first, then knowledge, and so on. In reality, an individual giver's development can be unpredictable. Different experiences--many of which you'll never know

about--can bounce a prospect among these different stages. And you may not even identify a prospect until he or she is well into the process.) We've described the process you hope to encourage. Now let's look at how we can help lead people through that process.

The Players

Here's a scenario common at many institutions: The major gifts committee--sometimes staff members, sometimes volunteers--will sit around a table and talk about the top prospects. As each name comes up, someone will say, "Oh, I'll take Harry," or "I'll take Cynthia."

These people are full of good will and the right motives. And this is appropriate at annual or special gift levels. But for the top gifts, these people might not be the best ones to coordinate and develop the relationship. For this, you must identify the prospect's natural partners at the institution. What individuals on campus are in touch with the prospect? Perhaps the prospect still corresponds with an old professor. Perhaps a relative or friend of the prospect is enrolled as a student. Anyone might end up being a link. For example, one of our leading benefactors became friends with a campus gardener because he tendeda garden that was named in her honor.

These natural partners are in the best position to tell you what kind of contact would be most significant to that prospect and, in some cases, to help you make that contact.

From among these people, consider who might be willing to help you with building the relationship. You won't ask them to solicit; you won't send them any formal progress reports or computer printouts. Their role is simply to help you involve the prospect more deeply with the institution. It's important that you don't interfere with the natural friendship, and under no circumstances should the partner feel manipulated. Most often, you'll find these people happy to help their friends receive the attention and recognition you want to provide.

Once you've identified the prospect's campus connections, your contacts with the prospect will involve people in three different roles:

* The primary player: This is the natural partner in the best position to monitor the prospect's relationship with the institution. He or she keeps a hand on the pulse of that relationship.

* Secondary players: These natural partners help guide and carry out contacts with the prospective giver. They provide ideas and feedback about the prospect's interests and concerns.

* The moves manager: This person—you or a member of your staff— works with the primary and secondary players, tracks the prospect's progress, and makes sure the institution maintains sufficient and appropriate contact with the prospect.

On occasion—for example, if the prospect is also a volunteer for the development office--the moves manager will actually come into direct contact with the prospective giver. More likely, the moves manager simply guides and assists the people who already have natural connections with the prospect. Bear in mind that these prospects tend to be most interested in dealing with the people who work on the projects they support. Rarely will they consider a fund raiser their first or mostimportant link with the institution. If you impose yourself artificially into the giver's relationship with the institution, you may hamper that relationship. Instead, let your own involvement grow naturally.

Taking Initiatives

Individual contacts made at random won't in themselves move a person toward commitment. Your efforts must have:

* quality,
* quantity,
* frequency, and
* continuity.

Without these four characteristics, your ultimate gift fundraising may be ineffective and inefficient-perhaps even a costly distraction. In other words, your institution must enter the life of your prospect in some substantive way every fewweeks over a long period of time. If your contacts are inappropriate or sporadic, your prospect's ultimate gift will probably go to a cause with which he or she is more closely involved.

We can class the contacts you initiate in two categories.

1. Foreground initiatives are activities planned with a specific prospect in mind. For example, you might:

* Arrange a visit from the president.
* Plan a private lunch with faculty members.
* Hold a testimonial dinner.
* Report to the prospect on the impact of his or her last gift.
* Send a card to congratulate the prospect on a business success.
* Use the prospect's home for a reception.
* Borrow art for a campus showing.
* Get a student to write to express thanks for a scholarship.
* Ask for advice in the prospect's area of expertise.
* Borrow the prospect's private plane to bring a VIP to campus.
* Give the prospect an award for distinguished service.
* Name a classroom for the prospect.
* Offer special seating for campus shows or events.

2. Background initiatives are activities or services planned for groups of people that may include one or more prospects. For example:

* visiting committees;
* advisory councils;
* alumni clubs;
* class reunions;
* student recruitment interviewing;
* annual reports, alumni periodicals, brochures, and other publications;
* films, videos, and slide shows;
* receptions and dinners; or
* campus tours.

Sometimes the same event can serve as both a foreground initiative for one person and a background initiative for another. For example, when we dedicated the Smith's laboratory, we invited 200 people out to the farm in the Adirondacks. We pitched a circus tent, served meals, and expressed thanks. That event was a foreground initiative for the Smiths--one action in a long string of contacts that had gone on for manyyears.

The event also served as a background initiative for the guests who attended. As it happened, one of those guests--a neighbor of the Smiths and a Cornell alumnus--struck up an acquaintance there with the dean of our College of Agriculture and Life Sciences, who was the son of one of the guest's classmates. The resulting friendship led within a year to the guest's gift of his own Adirondack farm. After eight years and many meaningful contacts, this man left Cornell an eight-figure bequest, the largest in theuniversity's history.

Managing The Moves

You've identified prospective givers and their natural campus partners. You understand what sort of initiatives you might make. How do you put all these things together into a coherent program of regular contacts, or, as we call them, "moves"?

To begin with, consider each move as a series of six steps:

1. Review the prospect's relationship with the institution regularly.
2. Plan, in consultation with your primary and secondary players, what sort of contact would be most appropriate next.
3. Coordinate that plan with the players involved
4. Execute the plan.
5. Evaluate its impact.
6. Record and report the move to the appropriate staff or players.

Although I'd recommend reviewing each prospect's status monthly, the time it takes to complete a move can vary widely. If the right move is simply to write a letter or make a phone call, those six steps can happen very quickly. But sometimes the right move is to pitch a circus tent and invite 200 people to dinner—and take six months planning it.

When you start thinking about the numbers of contacts that you need and the numbers of people involved in making these contacts, the sheer volume of activity starts to look impossible. And it would be, except for the saving grace that many of these experiences happen spontaneously.

Obviously, background initiatives require much less of the manager's time than do foreground initiatives. A skilled moves manager can handle perhaps 400 foreground initiatives per year. Since most prospects will experience as many background moves as they do foreground moves, we can assume that one ultimate gift fund raiser can be responsible for about 70 prospects. In an ideal world, one staff person would handle half that many prospects—about 35.

At Cornell, which started its major gift program in 1973, we have seven staff members serving as moves managers, at both major and special gift levels. Among them, they manage moves for about 1,180 top prospects and track some 1,200 givers at a lower level of involvement.

For a program of this size, we've found a computer essential for tracking prospects. When we began the program, and we were tracking fewer than 200 prospects, we did all our work on an office word processor. Now we use the university mainframe, and Cornell's programmers have developed a tracking program to suit a special approach.

The computer allows us to store contact information for each prospect and automatically distributes information to the appropriate staff members and those key players who should receive reports. Most important, though, it provides a tangible record of what led up to each major gift. These records provide the perfect education for new staff members and faculty who are unfamiliar with the fund-raising process.

The Heart Of The Matter

Even if you have a small staff and no computer, though, don't think you can't apply these concepts to cultivate your top prospects. In fact, an institution with a small donor base or a small fund-raising program needs this approach more than a larger institution does, simply because you must make the most of every potential giver.

To begin, start small. Identify five or 10 of your best prospects. Then identify their natural partners and think of those people in terms of primary and secondary. And with utter faithfulness, review every month. Plan contacts as necessary and keep records by hand.

Remember, just because an ultimate gift may be 30 years in the making, that doesn't mean you'll have to wait 30 years to see results. Even if you haven't been actively managing prospect's moves, some moves are still going on. Your prospects' relationships are with the institution, and your institution does all manner of things to build relationships whether a fund raiser is there to watch it or not.

In fact, that last point is vital. If we want to go beyond the annual and special gifts to the gifts that are of the greatest importance to the giver, we need to look beyond our own particular needs and campaigns and causes. We must look instead at the needs and interests of the giver and respond to those needs—even as we go about the business of serving our institution. At base, the heart of our business isn't charitable lead trusts and bequests and gifts of real estate. And it isn't even moves and initiatives. It's human values and human purposes. Those are the things people will commit themselves to. And it's those values and purposes that make our givers friends for life.

David Dunlop, a development officer for Cornell University from 1959 until his retirement in 1997, founded the university's major and principal gifts programs. In January 1987, Dunlop received CASE District II's first James L. Fisher Award for professional achievement. This article is based on an interview with CURRENTS' former associate editor, Robin Netherton.